

Dead to Sin, Alive to God

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Our Sin

And falling to the ground, he heard a voice saying to him, “Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting me?”

Acts 9:4

We are often blind to our own sin. I have seen examples of this in CCF leaders and participants alike, and I myself have been often reminded by my brothers and sisters. When Jesus called Saul, He opened his eyes to the depths of his sins. Only then could he repent and be transformed.

Saul persecuted the Christians. What have we done in CCF? The same tongue we use to praise God is also used for gossip and foolish talk. As leaders, we have failed to take care of the different members of the same body entrusted to us. We have shown we are not worthy of imitation, yet we reject reminders from those who want to win us over. I am guilty of every single one of these.

For the wages of sin is death...

Romans 6:23

Throughout the Old Testament, sin affected the relationship between God and the Israelites, and that among the Israelites themselves. We see for example in Judges 19-21 the devastation of sin begetting sin. I have personally experienced how my sin affected my relationship with God and my neighbours. So long as we are slaves to sin, our backs are to God, and the end is death.

...Do you not know that a little leaven leavens the whole lump?

1 Corinthians 5:6

God's Grace

For God so loved the world, that he gave his only Son, that whoever believes in him should not perish but have eternal life.

John 3:16

Our Response

But now that you have been set free from sin and have become slaves of God, the fruit you get leads to sanctification and its end, eternal life.

Romans 6:22

Being free of sin, through the grace of Jesus Christ, we can finally focus on our goal: to give glory to God.

In the same way, let your light shine before others, so that they may see
your good works and give glory to your Father who is in heaven.

Matthew 5:16

Repentance

I acknowledge my sin to you,
and I did not cover my iniquity;
I said, "I will confess my transgressions to the LORD",
and you forgave the iniquity of my sin.

Psalms 32:5

To repent is to hate sin and love God. This is not to say that Christians cannot sin, but we remain slaves of righteousness.

For I do not do the good I want, but the evil I do not want is what I keep on doing.

Romans 7:19

I believe it is beneficial for CCF to emphasise on the importance of confession in prayer. If possible, I hope to shape CCF into a place where brothers and sisters sharing about their struggles and praying for one another, because unfruitful works of darkness needs to be exposed by light for us to walk as children of light. This could be a theme brought up in bible study, or through short prayer activities at the start of the night, similar to God sightings.

Therefore, confess your sins to one another and pray for one another, that you may be
healed. The prayer of a righteous person has great power as it is working.

James 5:16

Praise

I have told the glad news of deliverance in the great congregation;
behold, I have not restrained my lips,
as you know, O LORD.

Psalms 40:9

If the gospel truly is good news, how could we keep it to ourselves? We have sinned, but He has justified. We have tasted and seen that the Lord is good. The immediate response is to proclaim the good news. As a Christian community, we can respond to God's grace through encouragement and outreach. Encouragement for our brothers and sisters in the fellowship who may be suffering or weak in faith, and outreach to those who Jesus has commanded us to make disciples of.

Let everything that has breath praise the LORD!
Praise the LORD!

Psalms 150:6